SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

ASSESSING THE ENVIRONMENTALLY RESPONSIBLE BEHAVIOR OF TOURIST IN AGUSAN DEL NORTE

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN TOURISM MANAGEMENT

By

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

		Pages
TITLE PAGE		i
CERTIFICATE OF PANEL APPROVAL		ii
ABSTRACT		iii
DEDICATION		iv
ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS		v
TABLE OF CONTENTS		vi
LIST OF TABLES		viii
LIST OF FIGURES		x
CHAPTER		
1	**THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE**	1
	1.1 Background of the study	1
	1.2 Review of Related Literature	5
	1.3 Theoretical Framework	18
	1.4 Schematic Diagram	21
	1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study	22
	1.6 Hypothesis	23
	1.7 Definition of Terms	23
2	**RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**	26
	2.1 Research Design	26
	2.2 Research Locale	26
	2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample	27
	2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan	28
	2.5 Research Ethical Standards	29
	2.6 Data Gathering Procedure	32
	2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure	32
3	**RESULTS AND DISCUSSIONS**	
	3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data	
	3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output	
4	**SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS**	
	4.1 Summary	
	4.2 Conclusion	
	4.3 Recommendations	

REFERENCES
CURRICULUM VITAE
APPENDICES
CERTIFICATE OF TECHNOLOGY BASED ASSESSMENT
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SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA
College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

CERTIFICATE OF RESEARCH APPROVAL

This thesis entitled **" ASSESSING THE ENVIRONMENTALLY RESPONSIBLE BEHAVIOR OF TOURIST IN AGUSAN DEL NORTE: CARMEN AND BUENAVISTA"** presented and submitted by **KYLA JANE M. HADA-ONG, KIAN MARIE L. BAGO, MA. LOURDES G. ALINDOG, REAH MYCA BIASCA, XAVIER JOHN ESCOLANO, KYLA JANE AFRICANO** in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Science in Tourism Management** is hereby accepted and recommended for Oral Examination.

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ABSTRACT

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I. OBJECTIVES

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III. FINDINGS

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IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

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RESEARCH DESIGN -refers To The Specific Approach Use In The Research E.x. DESCRIPTIVE QUALITATIVE

Objectives
- Write a short introduction of your paper. Provide the direction of the study and nuances.

Methodology
- Provide the specific method that was used in your paper and the important details such as how did you do it.

Findings
- Highlight the significant findings of your paper.

Recommendation

DEDICATION

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Structure of a Dedication

1.Opening Statement

•Example: *"This thesis is dedicated to...*

2. List and Explanation

•Example: *"To my parents, for their love and support,*

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

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Suggested Structure

Opening Statement
• Express general gratitude for the opportunity to complete the research or thesis.

Acknowledgment of Advisors and Professors
• Thank your thesis advisor, committee members, or professors for their guidance and expertise.

Acknowledgment of Family and Friends
•Thank those who provided emotional or financial support.

Acknowledgment of Institutional or Financial Support
•Recognize scholarships, grants, or organizations that funded or facilitated your research.

Special Thanks (Optional)
Mention individuals who provided significant help, such as peers, mentors, or technical staff.

Closing Statement
•Conclude with a general expression of gratitude.

Example

I am deeply grateful to everyone who contributed to

LIST OF TABLES

Table	Pages
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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

Tourism will continue to promote economic growth and community development worldwide, but it will also pose environmental challenges such as pollution, waste generation, and habitat degradation. In the Philippines, expanding tourism will support local and national economies while increasing pressure on fragile ecosystems, a trend also seen in Agusan del Norte. In Carmen and Buenavista, tourism activities will further grow, generating economic benefits alongside rising ecological pressures. To sustain natural resources, tourists will need to adopt Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB), which will be influenced by factors such as environmental commitment, social influence, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, and tourist value perception. This study will examine how these determinants shape tourists' Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB), providing insights for sustainable tourism development in the area.

International studies further emphasize that Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB) is influenced by multiple, interacting factors rather than a single determinant. Related studies emphasize that research on tourism and environmentally responsible behavior should be synthesized by identifying common themes such as experiential influences, emotional drivers, and service quality factors rather than presented as a sequence of individual findings, in order to achieve clearer analysis and stronger

conceptual coherence (Zhang et al., 2022; Bhatti & Alnasser, 2023; T. E. Cheng et al., 2021). Studies in educational and urban forest contexts note that knowledge, social norms, well-being, and perceived control shape sustainable behaviors (Y. Wang et al., 2023) (Z. Wang et al., 2023) (Zhao & Weng, 2024). Moreover, global research highlights that nature-induced awe and place attachment significantly contribute to responsible environmental actions (Jiang et al., 2022). (Erfanian et al., 2024) found that environmental knowledge itself affects how tourists act. A broader integrative perspective supports the idea that cognitive, emotional, and attitudinal dimensions collectively drive environmentally responsible behavior (Kement et al., 2021). These international insights reinforce that ERB is a multidimensional construct shaped by experience, emotion, awareness, social influence, and personal values.

Strong and sustainable tourism policies are essential for minimizing the environmental impacts of tourism. (Sotelo et al., 2025) emphasize the need for improved site management, stricter environmental regulations, and increased education on responsible travel behavior. These measures are necessary to ensure long-term environmental protection and sustainable tourism development.

Local studies in the Philippines further highlight the importance of strengthening pro-environmental behavior among both tourists and residents. (De Vera et al., 2023), using the Theory of Planned Behavior, found that attitude and subjective norms significantly influence intentions toward pro-environmental actions in riverside communities in

Cotabato City, Mindanao. Their findings suggest that conservation policies should be practical, accessible, and aligned with local social norms to encourage wider participation.

Pro-environmental behavior also supports broader international goals such as the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), UNESCO initiatives, and the ethical call to care for the environment emphasized in Laudato Si'. These global frameworks reinforce the responsibility of the tourism sector to protect natural and cultural resources.

Individual characteristics have likewise been linked to environmentally responsible behavior. (Nieva, 2024) notes that personality traits influence green behavior, which is essential for securing basic human needs such as clean air, water, food, safe housing, and a healthy environment. Supporting this, (Gabriel et al., 2024) found that tourism management students exposed to conservation and ecotourism courses demonstrate stronger environmental attitudes and behaviors.

From a destination perspective, competitiveness and sustainability must go hand in hand. (Palomar and Ylagan, 2024) argue that ecotourism destinations should establish a strong identity, limit access to protect natural resources, maintain a credible reputation, and continuously innovate sustainable products. Similarly, (Dela Cruz et al., 2024) emphasize the importance of protecting natural habitats and wildlife, providing

authentic cultural experiences, and ensuring local communities benefit through employment and skills development.

Understanding tourist behavior is central to sustainable destination management. (Simpao and Yabut, 2022) studied university students in Metro Manila and found that individuals exposed to environmental knowledge and sustainability initiatives are more likely to engage in conservation behavior. This highlights the role of education in shaping responsible tourism practices.

Finally, the growing demand for outdoor and adventure tourism underscores the urgency of sustainable planning. (Lonzaga, 2023) stresses the importance of well-managed ecotourism activities, while (Pacific et al., 2021) propose practical solutions for improving beach tourism management. The increasing popularity of outdoor adventure tourism (Pacific Journal et al., 2021) further indicates the need to better understand tourists' behavior to ensure environmental protection amid rapid industry growth.

Tourism in Carmen and Buenavista, Agusan del Norte will continue to grow and contribute to local economic development; however, without environmentally responsible behavior among tourists, this growth may intensify environmental degradation and threaten the sustainability of natural attractions. Despite this risk, there is limited localized empirical evidence that explains how tourists behave toward the environment and what factors influence such behavior in these emerging destinations.

Existing studies largely focus on established tourism areas, making their findings less applicable to the local context. This study is therefore necessary as it will provide baseline data on tourists' environmentally responsible behavior and identify key determinants that can guide local government units and tourism stakeholders in designing effective, evidence-based policies and interventions. By addressing this gap, the study will help ensure that tourism development in Carmen and Buenavista remains environmentally sustainable in the long term.

The results can guide local government units (LGUs) and tourism offices in creating policies and programs for environmental protection. This study is significant to local communities, environmental stakeholders, and policymakers as it highlights the role of sustainable tourism in promoting environmental protection and long-term community benefits. Its findings contribute to increased awareness and informed decision-making that support responsible tourism development and environmental stewardship.

The research will also promote awareness of simple green practices that tourists can adopt to help protect the environment. It highlights the need to train tourism employees and involve service providers so that sustainable practices become part of the local tourism culture. In addition, the study will benefit local government units, municipal tourism offices, community organizations, environmental agencies, and academic institutions, particularly the College of Tourism and Hospitality Management, as it provides research-based insights that can inform planning, policymaking, curriculum

enhancement, and community extension programs. This study contributes to the growing body of knowledge on environmental responsibility in Philippine tourism and can serve as a valuable reference for future research.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This Review of Related Literature presents relevant local and international studies that support the present research. It focuses on tourists' environmentally responsible behavior and the key factors influencing it, including environmental commitment, social influence, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, and tourist value perception. These studies provide a foundation for understanding the variables examined in this study.

Environmentally Responsible Behavior

Albattat (2024) believes that internal variables have a major influence on how environmentally conscious tourists behave. In order to create a cohesive discussion that is in line with the study's conceptual framework, the associated literature is further arranged into important theme areas, such as environmental commitment, social influence, visitor satisfaction, and tourist value perception.

These studies provide a strong foundation for the present research, which examines how individual characteristics such as gender and income influence tourists'

environmentally responsible actions in Agusan del Norte. Existing literature also highlights the importance of tourism experiences, showing that positive encounters and strong cultural attachment significantly enhance tourists' willingness to engage in environmental protection Z. Cheng & Chen (2022). Collectively, these findings underscore the importance of considering both internal factors and individual differences when analyzing environmentally responsible behavior.

Environmental education likewise plays a critical role in enhancing tourists' responsible actions. Results indicate that improved awareness, attitudes, and habits brought about by educational initiatives can significantly elevate Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB) (J. Wang et al., 2024). Such evidence aligns closely with the current study's focus on environmental knowledge as a key driver of responsible behavior. Educational efforts that strengthen tourists' understanding and environmental awareness contribute to shaping more sustainable habits and increasing their likelihood of engaging in eco-friendly actions.

In the context of the Philippines, determinants of eco-conscious travel further illustrate the importance of personal and motivational factors. A study conducted in Mindanao grounded in the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) revealed that tourists' attitudes, perceived behavioral control, and subjective norms play a major role in shaping green actions Binoya, (2024) . Findings also suggest that caring about the environment and being motivated to address issues lead to responsible environmental

behavior, whereas awareness alone is insufficient without strong behavioral intentions. These insights further justify examining personal factors such as gender and income to understand tourists' environmentally responsible behavior in Agusan del Norte.

Environmental Commitment

Environmental commitment has consistently been identified as a key predictor of pro-environmental and responsible behaviors in tourism. Studies show that actual and affective commitment significantly influence ecological actions, while attitudinal commitment provides strong overall support Hristova et al., (2025) . Environmental commitment also translates tourists' environmental knowledge and recreational experiences into concrete responsible behaviors, particularly in waste reduction, resource conservation, and respect for natural environments Cuong, (2025).

The role of perceived environmental responsibility further reinforces this concept. When individuals view an organization or destination as environmentally responsible, their own commitment strengthens, encouraging more pro-environmental behavior Shah et al., (2023). Likewise, environmental commitment mediates the relationship between tourists' knowledge, motivation, opportunities, and the actions they perform during travel, highlighting its importance as a behavioral mechanism (Tang et al., 2022). Emotional responses such as moral elevation, combined with environmental knowledge,

also shape stronger intentions and behaviors toward environmental protection (Ye et al., 2022).

Community-based and ecotourism research highlights how environmental commitment supports sustainability. In eco-tourism sites in Palawan, higher awareness and active participation in conservation activities were linked to a stronger sense of responsibility toward environmental protection (Gabileo et al., 2022). Although focused on local communities, the findings show that environmental knowledge and engagement foster commitment to sustainable practices. Similarly, a study in a Philippine “nature city” found that individuals with deeper or more active ecotourism involvement demonstrate stronger intrinsic commitment to ecological protection Aguilar & Domasian, (2023) suggesting that varying engagement levels predict different degrees of sustainable behavior. Ecotourism performance in Davao City including environmental education, conservation efforts, and community participation also enhanced tourists’ sustainable consciousness, reflecting key elements of environmental commitment such as awareness, values, and responsible action (Olivar et al., 2023). Collectively, these studies show that environmental commitment shaped by knowledge, engagement, and ecotourism experiences is a crucial predictor of environmentally responsible behavior.

Social Influence

The study of Masengu et al., (2025) stated that social media significantly influences travel decision-making by shaping tourists' perceptions through credibility, expert recommendations, and user-generated content. Travelers rely on reviews, images, and shared experiences as trusted sources, which affect destination choice, perceived value, and overall satisfaction. This highlights the central role of digital interactions in motivating travel and supporting destination marketing.

Social pressure and community influence also shape pro-environmental behavior (Iľko et al., 2025) found that women, older adults, and highly educated individuals are more sensitive to social traps, while social integration reduces perceived pressure and responsibility-shifting. Similarly, Simiyu et al., (2022) showed that environmentally responsible behaviors are more likely when peers and influential individuals demonstrate sustainable practices. X. Yang et al., (2021) further emphasized that family, peers, and media shape pro-environmental behavior by activating motivations and social norms that encourage green purchasing.

The mediating role of social influence is also evident in consumer settings Islam et al., (2024) demonstrated that social influence enhances sustainability consciousness and green purchase intentions, particularly among women, with social identity processes acting as key drivers. In contrast, Perry et al., (2021) highlighted that social norms have

limited impact on pro-environmental behavior when outcomes are uncertain, distant, or not directly observable. Wu et al., (2025) noted that other factors such as life satisfaction, social fairness, internet use, and differences in education, income, and political status play major roles in shaping residents' environmental actions in China.

Finally, Patisucan Tun & Gilitwala, (2022) found that among millennials in Metro Manila, subjective norms, environmental concern, perceived behavioral control, and brand image significantly influence intentions to purchase environmentally sustainable clothing, confirming the applicability of the Theory of Planned Behavior in explaining green consumer behavior.

Destination Eco- Friendly Reputation

A destination's eco-friendly reputation strongly influences tourists' choices, especially among environmentally conscious travelers. Promoting green initiatives and eco-responsible branding enhances perceived sustainability and attractiveness Nowacki et al., (2021). Transparent communication of sustainable practices, such as green certifications and tourism initiatives, further strengthens credibility and encourages selection by eco-aware tourists Rashmi Mishra, (2025).

Destinations projecting a strong environmental image promote participation in ecotourism activities like wildlife conservation and eco-tours, illustrating the impact of responsible branding on travel behavior Huo et al., (2024). Eco-destination image also

amplifies intrinsic motivations, such as environmental concern, increasing tourists' intention to visit sustainable destinations Chi & Pham, (2024).

Visible green practices, including waste reduction and renewable energy adoption, enhance a destination's eco-friendly reputation and competitive advantage Đorđević et al., (2024). Standardized environmental management and transparent reporting across ASEAN destinations further ensure credibility and attract eco-conscious tourists (STUDY TO DEVELOP A FRAMEWORK ON SUSTAINABLE TOURISM DEVELOPMENT IN ASEAN IN THE POST COVID-19 ERA, 2022) Locally, initiatives in Siruma, Camarines Sur such as waste management, wildlife conservation, and eco-friendly accommodations have been key in establishing a positive eco-destination image through stakeholder collaboration Estrella, (2024).

Tourist Satisfaction

The study of Zulvianti et al., (2023) stated that perceived environmental value and destination image significantly influence tourist satisfaction and loyalty, with religiosity moderating these relationships. Their findings also highlight that tourists who place high value on environmental quality tend to show greater loyalty, with satisfaction acting as a mediating factor. Tourist experience quality likewise shapes pro-environmental responses, as shown in research among visitors in natural sites in Madhya Pradesh Kumar & Lata, (2022).

Tourist satisfaction is further strengthened by environmental value and service quality. The study of Sahabuddin et al., (2024) showed that in the Sundarbans, perceived value and employee service quality significantly increase tourist satisfaction, which then predicts loyalty, environmental commitment, and environmentally responsible behavior. Service quality also emerges as a strong determinant of sustainable actions, as demonstrated in Praiijing Traditional Village, where higher service quality enhanced both satisfaction and place attachment, which in turn strengthened tourists' Evangeline et al., (2025).

Local studies similarly highlight the importance of sustainable management practices. Pontillas et al., (2025) found that residents of Barangay Hoyohoy in Tangub City appreciate socio-cultural benefits of tourism but express concern over environmental impacts, particularly gaps in sustainable development implementation. Effective resource protection also improves tourist experience, as (De Jesus & Ricafort, 2025) demonstrated in MIMAROPA, where strong environmental, cultural, and behavioral conservation practices significantly elevated visitor engagement and satisfaction. Their work proposes a management framework aimed at strengthening sustainability efforts in the region.

Intrinsic motivations additionally shape satisfaction and sustainable engagement. Research in Tinipak, Malaog, and Lawigue Caves in Quezon Province showed that novelty-seeking, socialization, knowledge, and escape motivations significantly increase

visitor satisfaction, confirming that meaningful and experiential motives enhance cave tourism experiences (Saniel et al., 2025) . The authors recommend improving guide training, facilities, and visitor engagement to support both tourist satisfaction and sustainable tourism practices.

Tourist Value Perception

The study of L. Yang et al., (2023) stated that ecotourists' perceived authenticity and values including emotional, functional, and environmental dimensions significantly influence their environmentally responsible behaviors (ERB). Similarly, H. Li et al., (2022) found that perceived value and social responsibility positively affect tourists' intentions to engage in low-carbon behaviors, showing that value perception drives pro-environmental actions.

Perceived value also shapes satisfaction and intentions. Kokkhangplu et al., (2023) reported that eco-friendly perceived value increases satisfaction and behavioral intentions toward eco-friendly hotels. M. Mengkebayaer, (2022) showed that good value for money and positive ecotourism experiences strengthen destination attachment and loyalty, reinforcing sustainable tourism behaviors.

In Philippine heritage tourism, (Gayeta & Ylagan, 2022) highlighted that perceived value of cultural heritage sites in CALABARZON boosts satisfaction, which drives revisit

intentions. At Lake Sebu, (Rey Pedroso, 2025) found that sustainable amenities and high service quality enhance tourists perceived value and eco-destination branding.

Community perception also supports sustainability. Dagdag, (2023) in Southern Cagayan Valley noted moderate ecotourism management and community perception, recommending collaborative programs to improve infrastructure, awareness, and responsible tourism.

Finally, Quiapo & Chavez, (2024) demonstrated that tourists perceived value and satisfaction significantly influence environmental competence, including awareness and engagement in sustainable practices.

Gender

Gender can shape how people see and practice eco-friendly actions. Men and women often have different views, set other priorities, and take various steps to live sustainably. Understanding these differences helps communities create plans that let everyone play an active role in protecting nature and making tourism last. For example, (Osman & Brown, 2024) found that female tourists tend to value environmental cleanliness, safety, and eco-friendly amenities, while male tourists focus more on accessibility and recreational features. These distinctions show how gendered perceptions can influence how people engage with environmental practices and sustainable tourism.

Values influence people's travel behavior. Among Southeast Asian nature tourists, women place more importance on nature contact and social interaction, whereas men will tend to prioritize scenery and adventure (Saidon et al., 2024). Tourism managers are able to use these differences in messaging and program to encourage men and women to behave responsibly towards the environment.

Travel habits also differ by gender. In Cebu, women were more active in trip planning and placed greater emphasis on safety, cleanliness, and children. Men, meanwhile, paid more attention to price and convenience (Resos et al., 2025). Offering gender-responsive environmental education, such as empowering women in conservation and providing services that consider men's interests, can encourage both groups to choose greener behaviors.

Age

Age affects how tourists think about the environment and how they act. Many younger tourists are more aware of environmental issues and take part in eco-friendly actions, while older tourists may have different motivations based on their life experiences. Understanding these differences helps places like Carmen and Buenavista design programs that speak to each age group and encourage everyone to join sustainability efforts.

Studies indicate that younger generations, like Gen Z, are more likely to hold pro-environment attitudes compared to older generations (Ribeiro et al., 2023). This implies

social norms and the values of each generation influence how tourists comprehend and implement sustainability. Messages must be more effective by being aligned with what appeals to each generation: emphasize moral purpose and innovation for younger tourists, and legacy, usefulness, and practicality for older tourists. This personalization is what can help environmental programs serve all people more effectively.

Youth involvement is key in the Philippine tourist sites. In Palawan, most visitors were 18–24 years old and were more likely to engage in sustainable activities, helped by exposure to campaigns and social media (Cahigas et al., 2023). For Carmen and Buenavista, using youth-friendly communication platforms and offering age-appropriate programs for older visitors can teach people of all ages to care for the environment over the long term.

Educational Attainment

Education changes how travelers see and treat the environment. People with more schooling usually know more about sustainability and are more likely to do green actions. Adding quick tips to tours, signs, and guides helps people act appropriately to care for natural places and local (Šimková et al., 2023). The most effective approach is hands-on and community-led: work with local leaders, plan activities together, and let people learn by doing so, knowledge turns into action (Ewa Duda, 2022).

Evidence from the Philippines rings with similar developments. In Camiguin Province, tourists with higher education levels exhibited greater consistency in waste management, the reduction of plastic consumption, and adherence to local regulations.

People with higher education often exhibit more consistent, sustainable habits than those with less education. This suggests that education can shape attitudes and encourage green behavior (King-Chan et al., 2020). However, education alone does not always lead to responsible actions. In Liliw, Laguna, a study of tourists at Kilangin Falls found no strong link between education level and what people knew, felt, or did about sustainability (Julius B, 2025).

These mixed results show that what happens on-site really matters. Simple, in-the-moment tools can help clear signs at key spots (like trash and recycling areas), quick reminders about what most visitors do ("Most people pack out their trash"), brief talks from guides, and short interactive tips before activities. Even without much formal schooling, these nudges can lead visitors to make more eco-friendly choices.

Income

A tourist's disposable income affects how willing and able they are to act in eco-friendly ways. People with higher incomes often have more access to green options, like eco-lodging or reusable gear, though some still care a lot about price. That is why destinations should offer low-cost or free choices for everyone, clear waste stations, water refills, borrow-a-bag programs, or shuttle discounts so that all visitors can act

responsibly. Reviews also point to income as a key factor that makes green decisions easier (J. Li et al., 2024).

In Rizal, individuals with more stable incomes contributed more to environmental initiatives in local government-operated ecotourism destinations (Sarinas et al., 2023). In Palaui Island, ecotourism revenue boosted residents' concern for preserving coastal assets (Ballad et al., 2021). This research centers on residents, not visitors, but it indicates that financial incentives can induce well-behaved visitor conduct as well. Practical solutions include tiered pricing of eco-services, discounts or packages for low-impact choices, and setting aside part of tourism income for overtly visible conservation activities. These measures can encourage both lower- and upper-income tourists to adopt greener practices.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study is anchored on the Value–Belief–Norm (VBN) Theory proposed by Stern et al. (1999), which explains pro-environmental behavior as a progression from values to beliefs and personal norms that guide individual actions. In this study, tourist value perception reflects the value component of the theory, as it represents tourists' underlying environmental and altruistic values toward sustainable tourism. These values influence beliefs about environmental consequences and responsibility, which are operationalized through environmental commitment, indicating the individual's sense of obligation to protect the environment. Meanwhile, social influence aligns with the

normative component of the theory, as it captures perceived social expectations and moral norms that reinforce environmentally responsible behavior. Together, these variables explain how internal values, reinforced by social norms, shape tourists' commitment to environmentally sustainable practices. In the tourism context, tourists' environmental commitment reflects deeply held biospheric values that motivate them to protect the natural environment. When tourists perceive a destination as eco-friendly or gain meaningful experiences from its attractions, these experiences strengthen their beliefs about environmental protection, making them more aware of ecological consequences and more compelled to act responsibly during their visit.

Complementing this perspective, the Norm Activation Model introduced by Schwartz (1977) highlights the psychological mechanisms through which personal moral norms are activated. The Norm Activation Model proposes that pro-environmental behavior is more likely when two conditions awareness of consequences and ascription of responsibility are present. In tourism settings, when visitors recognize that irresponsible behavior can harm the destination, and when they feel accountable for preventing such harm, their personal norms toward responsible actions are strengthened. Positive experiences such as satisfaction and perceived value can further reinforce these feelings of obligation, motivating tourists to behave responsibly. Social influence also plays a significant role, as visible environmental practices, community norms, and travel companions can reinforce what is morally appropriate, aligning with Schwartz's assertion that social cues can activate or strengthen personal norms.

To further explain behavioral intention, this study is also grounded in the Theory of Planned Behavior, formulated by (Ajzen, 1991) The Theory of Planned Behavior posits that behavior is shaped by three core components: attitude toward the behavior, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control. In tourism, a positive attitude toward environmentally responsible behavior such as believing it is beneficial or necessary strengthens a tourist's intention to act responsibly. Subjective norms, which refer to social pressures or expectations from peers, locals, or the tourism environment, further influence tourists perceived obligation to behave appropriately. Perceived behavioral control reflects a tourist's belief in their capability to engage in responsible actions, such as reducing waste, respecting wildlife, or supporting sustainable practices. When tourists feel capable and supported, their intention to act responsibly increases. The Theory of Planned Behavior also provides theoretical support for the inclusion of social influence, as it recognizes the role of perceived social expectations in shaping behavior.

Taken together, the Value–Belief–Norm Theory, the Norm Activation Model, and the Theory of Planned Behavior offer a comprehensive framework for understanding the determinants of tourists' environmentally responsible behavior. The Value–Belief–Norm Theory explains how values shape beliefs and moral norms, the Norm Activation Model clarifies the activation of personal norms through awareness and responsibility, and the Theory of Planned Behavior highlights the role of attitudes, perceived control, and subjective (social) norms. By integrating these theoretical perspectives, the present

study is well-positioned to examine how environmental commitment, eco-friendly destination reputation, tourist satisfaction, value perception, and social influence collectively contribute to environmentally responsible behavior among tourists.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

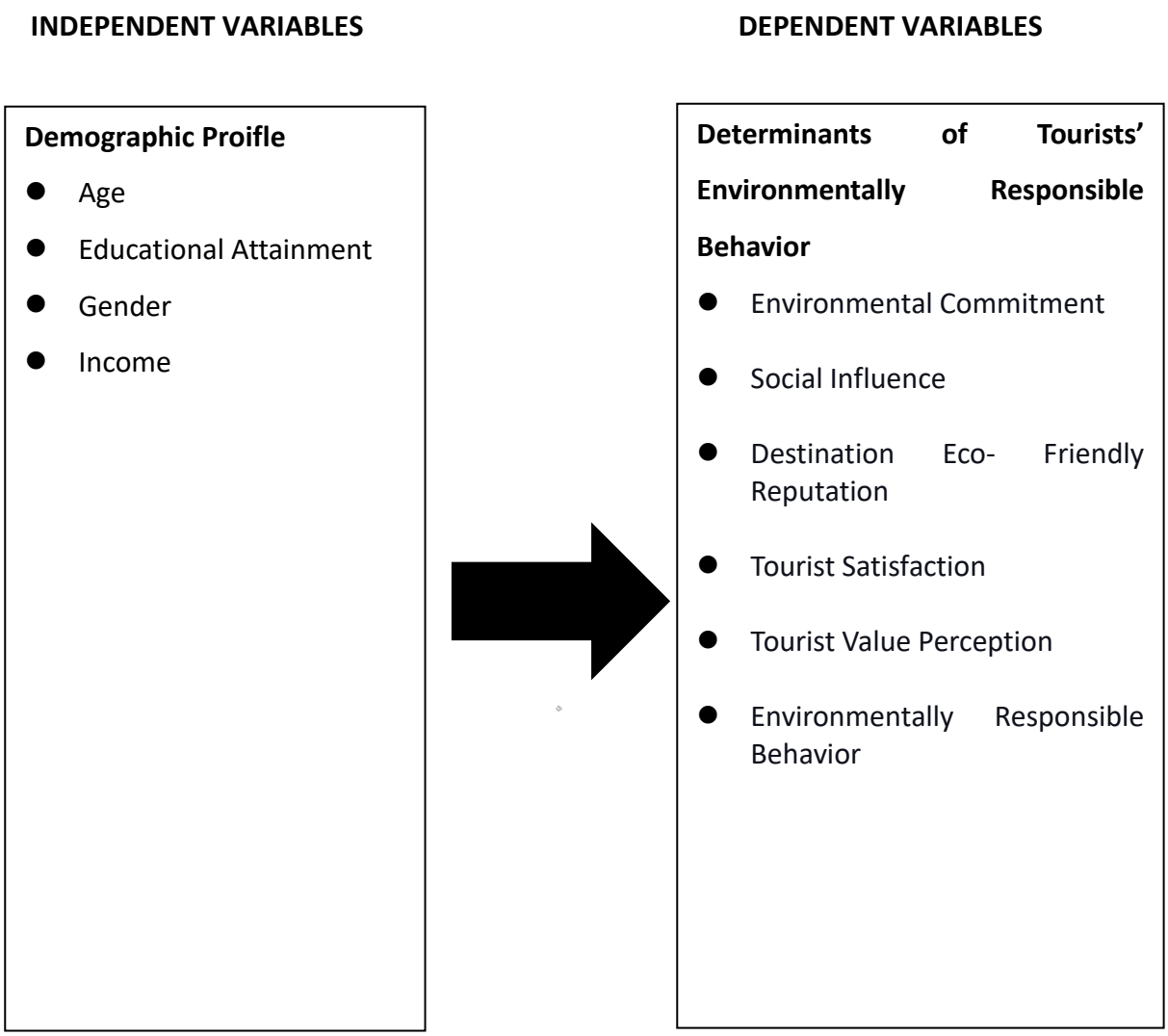


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

This study will aim to determine the demographic profile of tourists and will examine the determinants of their Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB). Specifically, it will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the demographic profile of the tourists in terms of:

1.1. gender;

1.2. age;

1.3. educational attainment; and

1.4. income?

2. What is the level of the determinants influencing tourists' Environmentally Responsible Behaviour in terms of:

2.1. environmental commitment;

2.2. social influence;

2.3. destination eco-friendly reputation;

2.4. tourist satisfaction;

2.5. tourist value perception; and

2.6. environmentally responsible behavior?

3. Is there a significant relationship between the demographic profile of the tourists and the determinants of their Environmentally Responsible Behavior?



1.6 Hypothesis

H_o There is no significant relationship between the demographic profile of the tourists and the determinants of their Environmentally Responsible Behavior.

Scope and Limitations

This study will focus on determining the factors that will influence the Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB) of tourists who will visit the municipalities of Carmen and Buenavista in Agusan del Norte. It will examine the following variables: environmental commitment, social influence, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, tourist value perception, and environmentally responsible behavior. The scope of the study will be limited only to tourists who will be visiting the selected sites within the study area and will not include residents, business owners, tourism operators, local government officials, or other community stakeholders. Data will be collected through a survey questionnaire that will be administered directly to tourist respondents. While the study will provide valuable insights into the determinants of tourists' environmentally responsible actions within a defined geographic context, its results will be constrained by the characteristics of the respondents, the sampling method that will be used, and the reliance on self-reported data.

1.7 Definition of Terms

For better understanding and classification, the following terms and words were operationally defined as follows:

Age. It will refer to the respondent's self-identified age category as indicated in the survey instrument. It will be recorded by asking respondents to select the option that will best represent their age group.

Destination Eco-Friendly Reputation. It will refer to how respondents will perceive the destination's environmental performance and sustainability image.

Educational Attainment. It will refer to the highest level of formal education that the respondent will have completed. The information will be gathered through a list of education levels that will be presented in the survey.

Environmental Commitment. It will refer to the degree to which respondents will express a personal intention and willingness to take part in actions that will protect and preserve the environment during their visit.

Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB). It will refer to the specific environmentally friendly actions that respondents will report performing or intending to perform during their visit.

Gender. It will refer to the respondent's self-identified gender category as indicated in the survey instrument. It will be recorded by asking respondents to select the option that will best represent their gender identity.

Income. It will refer to the respondent's average monthly earnings expressed in Philippine Peso. It will be measured through predetermined monthly income categories in the questionnaire.

Social Influence. It will refer to the extent to which respondents will perceive that their environmentally responsible behavior will be shaped or encouraged by the expectations, approval, or influence of people important to them.

Tourist Satisfaction. It will refer to the degree of contentment and positive experience that respondents will report regarding their visit to the destination.

Tourist Value Perception. It will refer to how respondents will evaluate the overall worth of their experience in relation to the time, effort, and resources they will spend during their visit.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1 Research Design

This study will use a quantitative, descriptive correlational research design. Surveys will be administered to tourists visiting Carmen and Buenavista, Agusan del Norte to measure the determinants of their Environmentally Responsible Behavior (ERB). The research instrument will be anchored on the study "An Investigation into the Factors of Tourists' Environmentally Responsible Behaviour" by Bhatti and Alnasser (2023), which identifies key predictors of tourists' ERB, including environmental commitment, social influence, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, tourist value perception, and environmentally responsible behavior. Guided by this framework, the study will collect numerical data that will describe tourists' environmental attitudes and actions and will examine how these determinants relate to their demographic characteristics. All survey items will be adapted from Bhatti and Alnasser's validated scales and their referenced sources and will use a 4-point Likert scale to capture respondents' levels of agreement. Overall, this design will provide a systematic and reliable method for assessing the factors that will influence tourists' environmentally responsible behavior in the selected destinations.

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted in the towns of Carmen and Buenavista in Agusan del Norte, both of which are recognized as popular tourist destinations in the province.

Pamela Beach Resort is a peaceful seaside getaway perfect for families, couples, and groups who want to relax and enjoy quality time by the sea. Its calm atmosphere and scenic views make it an ideal spot for leisure, bonding, and weekend escapes. Mars Cottages, is a small coastal accommodation that provides basic facilities for visitors looking for relaxation and leisure. Its beachfront location supports recreational activities and offers a calm environment for short stays.

Bolihon Beach Resort attracts visitors due to its scenic location where the sky and ocean appear to meet. The resort features stunning natural landscapes, including clear turquoise waters, visible corals, surrounding mountains, and wide open skies. One of the main attractions of the resort is Bolihon Point Cliff known as " Pang-Pang", a distinctive rock formation with a flat surface. This site is popular for cliff jumping and for providing visitors with a peaceful view of the horizon and the crashing waves.

Vinapor Blue Waters Resort, on the other hand, caters to families, couples, and local tourists seeking leisure and relaxation. Its facilities include a cave pool, outdoor swimming pools, cottages, sea-view rooms, and decorative animal figures placed throughout the property, making it appealing to visitors of different age groups. Their natural beauty will attract both local and outside visitors, making them suitable places to study how tourists will behave in eco-friendly ways.

Both towns face problems like improper waste disposal, low environmental awareness, and weak enforcement of environmental rules. These issues can damage their natural resources and hurt tourism in the long run. The study will measure how environmentally responsible tourists are in these areas and suggest practical steps to improve conservation and support sustainable tourism.

The College of Tourism and Hospitality Management at Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC), located on Brgy. 4 Atupan St., Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, supports this research. The department trains students to practice responsible tourism and care for the environment, which matches the study's goal of promoting sustainability in Agusan del Norte's tourism industry.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study will be conducted in selected tourist destinations in Carmen and Buenavista, Agusan del Norte, namely Bolihon Cove, Vinapor Blue Waters Beach Resort, Mars Cottages, and Pamela Beach Resort. These sites were chosen because they are among the most frequently visited destinations in the area, ensuring a sufficient and diverse population of tourists who can provide relevant data on environmentally responsible behavior. The study population will consist of an estimated 5,576 tourists visiting these sites during the data collection period.

Purposive sampling will be employed to ensure that only respondents who can meaningfully contribute to the objectives of the study are included. This sampling method was selected because the study specifically focuses on tourists' environmentally

responsible behavior, which requires respondents to have actual on-site tourism experience. Using a standard sample size computation, 588 respondents will be selected to adequately represent the tourist population and to allow reliable statistical analysis.

Tourists will be included as respondents if they meet the following criteria: (1) they are non-residents of Carmen and Buenavista, (2) they are at least 18 years old to ensure informed consent, and (3) they are currently visiting a tourist site within the study area at the time of data collection. Data will be gathered through a structured survey questionnaire administered directly to qualified tourist respondents at the selected destinations.

Table 1. Distribution of the Respondents

	Population		Sample			
	Male	**Female**	**Male**	**Female**	**Total**	**Percentage**
Pamela Beach Resort	1,394	1,633	70	82	151	42.88
Mars Cottages	536	652	27	33	59	16.83
Bolihon Cove	1,773	1,931	89	97	185	52.46
Vinapor Blue Waters Beach Reseort	1,873	1,982	94	99	193	54.60
Total	**5,576**	**6,198**	**279**	**310**	**588**	**167**

Table 1 shows the distribution of respondents of the study.



2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

Research Instrument

The research instrument for this study is anchored on the framework proposed by Bhatti and Alnasser (2023) and has been modified to suit the local tourism context of Carmen and Buenavista, Agusan del Norte.

The questionnaire will include the following variables: environmental commitment, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, tourist value perception, social influence, and environmentally responsible behavior. Environmental commitment will be measured using indicators that will assess tourists' willingness to protect the environment, comply with environmental rules, and support conservation efforts during their visit. Destination eco-friendly reputation will be measured through indicators that will capture tourists' perceptions of cleanliness, waste management practices, environmental policies, and sustainability initiatives in the destination. Tourist satisfaction will be measured using indicators related to overall satisfaction with the visit, quality of services, and environmental conditions.

Tourist value perception will be measured through indicators that will evaluate tourists' assessment of the benefits received relative to the time, cost, and effort spent. Social influence will be measured using indicators that will assess the extent to which companions, tourism personnel, local communities, and social norms will influence

tourists' environmental behavior. Environmentally responsible behavior will be measured using indicators that will capture tourists' actions such as proper waste disposal, resource conservation, respect for natural attractions, and adherence to environmental guidelines.

To modify the instrument, the wording of selected items will be localized by incorporating site-specific situations and commonly observed environmental practices in Carmen and Buenavista, while preserving the original intent of each construct. The modified instrument will undergo expert validation and pilot testing to establish validity and reliability before its actual administration. All items will be rated using a 4-point Likert scale to ensure consistency and clarity of responses.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The study will follow copyright rules. All books, articles, and other sources will be cited correctly. No new technology or products needing patents or trademarks will be created. Findings will be original, and proper credit will be given to avoid plagiarism. All data will be used only for academic purposes.

B. Informed Consent

Participants will be tourists in Carmen and Buenavista, Agusan del Norte. Before joining, they will receive a clear verbal or written explanation of the study's purpose, what it will involve, possible benefits, and any minor risks. Each participant will sign a

consent form. Participation will be voluntary, and anyone may stop at any time without penalty.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

Personal information will be kept private. Data will be anonymized, so names will not appear in the report. The consent form will explain how data will be used, stored, and protected. Only the research team will access raw data, which will be kept in password-protected files and devices. Anonymized data will not be shared without permission.

D. Voluntary Participation

Participation will be entirely voluntary. Tourists may decline without pressure and may withdraw at any time. No animals will be involved in this study.

E. Minimization of Harm

The study will involve minimal risk. Surveys will be conducted respectfully and will not cause physical, emotional, or psychological harm. Anyone who feels uncomfortable can stop immediately. A professional setting will be maintained. Since no animals will be involved, animal-research rules will not apply.

F. Beneficence

The study will aim to improve eco-friendly tourism in Agusan del Norte and support better local policies and practices. Results will guide future planning. Participants will be able to request a summary of the findings.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants will be selected fairly from tourists in Carmen and Buenavista. No discrimination will occur. Anyone who meets the criteria and is willing and available at the survey time will be able to join.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

Standard procedures will be used to collect accurate data. The questionnaire will be pre-tested and given in the same way to all participants. Leading questions will be avoided, bias will be reduced, and results will be analyzed objectively. Any limits or possible errors will be reported.

I. Transparency in Reporting

Findings will be reported honestly, with no data manipulation. All sources will be cited correctly. Any use of digital tools or AI will be disclosed.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

No patented materials will be used. Literature, images, and software tools will be cited and used legally and ethically.

K. Ethical Considerations for Human Subjects

Participants will be told the risks and benefits and will be able to ask questions before deciding. No vulnerable groups will be targeted. All rules for research with human participants will be followed.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

AI tools (such as ChatGPT) will help with summarizing, organizing, and checking grammar. Tools like Google Scholar, Elicit, and Grammarly will support searching and editing. All AI-assisted content will be reviewed, and conclusions will rely on human judgment.

M. Ethical Approval

Before data collection, the study will receive approval from the Institutional Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga. This will ensure compliance with rules for human participants, data protection, and ethical research.

2.6 Data Gathering Procedure

First, the researchers sent a request letter to the Tourism Office Heads of Carmen and Buenavista, which was verified by the CTHM Dean to obtain the official list of prospective respondents for the study. Next, this list was forwarded to the statistician to ensure the accuracy and consistency of the population. After the population was confirmed, the researchers crafted the research instrument based on the anchored study and conducted a validity test to ensure that the items were accurate and appropriate for the respondents. Following validation, pilot testing was conducted, and the results were submitted to the statistician to establish the reliability of the instrument. Once the instrument was confirmed valid and reliable, the researchers sent an approval letter to the CTHM Dean to secure permission to conduct the actual data collection. Upon approval, the researchers personally distributed the survey

questionnaires to the identified respondents. After all responses were collected, the researchers tallied, encoded, and checked the data, then submitted the results to the statistician to verify accuracy and reliability. Finally, the verified data were analyzed, interpreted, and discussed in accordance with the objectives of the study.

Letter of Request. The researchers submitted a formal request letter to the Tourism Office Heads, which was reviewed and verified by the CTHM Dean to ensure proper authorization and identification of respondents.

Survey Questionnaire. The researchers crafted and adapted the research instrument from a reliable anchored study, ensuring that all questions were relevant, clear, and suitable for the respondents. The instrument was tested for validity and reliability through statistical consultation and pilot testing.

Informed Consent. Before distributing the questionnaires, the researchers obtained informed consent from the respondents, who voluntarily agreed to participate. Minors participated only with the guidance and consent of their parents or guardians.

Consolidation of Data. The researchers gathered, checked, tallied, encoded, and assessed the collected data. The processed data were submitted to the statistician for verification of accuracy and reliability, after which the verified data were analyzed, interpreted, and discussed in line with the objectives of the study.



2.7 Data Analysis Plan and Procedure

Statistical Treatment

In presenting, analyzing, and interpreting the data, the researchers will use the following statistical tools:

Frequency and Percentage

These will be used for SOP 1 to determine the demographic profile of the tourists in terms of gender, age, educational attainment, and income. Frequency will show how many respondents fall under each category, while percentage will indicate the proportion of respondents belonging to each group.

Mean (Average)

The mean will be used for SOP 2 to measure the level of the determinants influencing tourists' Environmentally Responsible Behavior. Specifically, the mean will summarize the typical responses for environmental commitment, social influence, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, tourist value perception, and environmentally responsible behavior based on the 4-point Likert scale.

Correlational Analysis (Pearson's r)

Pearson's r will be applied for SOP 3 to determine whether there will be a significant relationship between the tourists' demographic profile and the determinants of their Environmentally Responsible Behavior. This statistical test will measure the strength and direction of the linear association between demographic variables (gender, age, educational attainment, income) and the ERB-related constructs (environmental

commitment, social influence, destination eco-friendly reputation, tourist satisfaction, tourist value perception, and environmentally responsible behavior).

CHAPTER 3

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

3.1 Presentation and Analysis of Data

3.2 Proposed Intervention/ Output

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CHAPTER 4

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, RECOMMENDATION,

4.1. Summary

4.2. Conclusion

4.3.Recommendation

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APPENDICES

CERTIFICATE OF AUTHENTIC AUTHORSHIP